
LIVEABOARD DIVE EXPEDITION

Raja Ampat with Brooke Pyke

A 10-day private liveaboard expedition through the Coral Triangle with award-winning underwater photographer Brooke Pyke. Damai II, around 30 dives, marine biology sessions, photography mentoring and a group capped at 12 guests.

DATES

Future dates TBC

DURATION

10 Days / 9 Nights

GROUP SIZE

Max 12 Guests

PAST PRICE

US\$8,950

HIGHLIGHTS

Raja Ampat done slowly, privately and with real underwater guidance

01

Private Damai II Charter

Nine nights aboard a luxury Indonesian liveaboard with generous deck space, ensuite cabins and a 12-guest cap.

02

Around 30 Dives

Dampier Strait, Aljui Bay, Penemu, Wayilbatan, Boo, Fiabacet, Farondi and Balbulol, with night dives included when conditions allow.

03

Brooke Pyke

Underwater photography, editing, field mentoring and visual storytelling support from an award-winning ocean photographer.

04

Marine Science

Guest scientist Dr. Amelia Armstrong brings manta ray expertise, marine biology presentations and interactive Q&A sessions.

05

Coral Triangle Wildlife

Oceanic mantas, reef mantas, turtles, wobbegongs, walking sharks, pygmy seahorses, sea fans and soft coral gardens.

06

All-Inclusive Ease

Gourmet meals, beverages, nitrox for certified divers, full rental equipment, massages, laundry and Airguides expedition support.

ABOUT THE EXPERIENCE

The ocean's crown jewel, explored properly

Raja Ampat sits in Indonesia's remote West Papua, at the heart of the Coral Triangle. It is one of the most biodiverse marine ecosystems on earth, with reefs that feel impossibly full of colour, movement and life.

This expedition is designed for divers who want more than a quick visit. The route begins in Sorong, then moves through Dampier Strait, Wayag, Aljui Bay, Misool and back through the islands, balancing big coral landscapes, macro dives, lagoons, viewpoints and night dives.

The source itinerary includes around 30 dives across 10 days, plus snorkelling, lagoon cruises, beach visits, hikes, workshops and marine biology sessions. The pace gives you time to settle into the reef rather than chase a checklist.

Certified divers are the natural fit, and the source file notes Open Water level or equivalent as the minimum. Snorkellers can also join the adventure, subject to final trip terms and route planning.



Raja Ampat rewards patience: currents, reef walls, macro life, mantas, sharks and coral gardens all shift with the conditions.

"Airguides were exceptional hosts for our Raja Ampat liveaboard dive trip. Seamless, professional and incredibly well organised from start to finish. A special mention to Brooke and Prashanti Pyke for their warmth, expertise and attention to detail."

Adam McKnight, Raja 2025

YOUR STORYTELLER GUIDE

Brooke Pyke

Brooke is a multi award-winning Australian underwater photographer, dive instructor and marine expedition guide whose work is grounded in ocean conservation and thoughtful storytelling.

Originally from Melbourne, Brooke found her way back to photography through scuba diving, then spent years working as a dive professional across Thailand, Indonesia and Australia. Her first professional underwater photography role came on Ningaloo Reef, where she now lives and works.

Raja Ampat is personal for Brooke. She has led small-group diving expeditions here since 2019, shaped around slower dives, private charters, respectful wildlife encounters and hands-on image mentoring in one of the most visually rich ocean environments on the planet.



"Photography and art have the power to ignite a passion for conservation in the next generation." – Brooke Pyke



WHY BOOK THIS EXPERIENCE?

Because Raja Ampat is too good to skim

Many visitors come to Raja Ampat to tick off mantas, pygmy seahorses or famous dive sites. Brooke's approach is different: stay longer, go deeper and build enough context to understand what you are seeing.

With a private charter, a 12-guest group and Damai II's experienced captain and dive crew, the route can respond to weather, current and guest needs while still aiming for the quieter corners that make the region feel wild.

For photographers, the value is not just access to subjects. Brooke is there for camera decisions, field support, editing, one-on-one feedback and the practical craft of making images that tell a meaningful ocean story.



DAY BY DAY

Your Raja Ampat liveaboard route

DAY		ARRIVAL
1	Arrival in Sorong Arrive in Sorong, transfer to the Swiss-Belhotel and settle in after your journey. That evening, meet Brooke, your hosts and fellow travellers for a welcome dinner before the liveaboard begins.	
DAY		BOARDING
2	Board Damai II The Damai II crew collects the group for boarding. After introductions, cabin allocation and light refreshments, set sail west toward Matan for the check-out dive.	
DAY		REEFS
3	Kri and Dampier Strait Explore Cape Kri, Blue Magic, Sardine Reef and Mioskon, with healthy coral gardens, schooling fish, reef sharks, wobbegong sharks and pygmy seahorses possible.	
DAY		MACRO
4	Aljai Bay Spend time in sheltered macro sites known for nudibranchs, seahorses, walking sharks and octopus. The source itinerary notes one of Brooke's favourite night dives here.	
DAY		LAGOONS
5	Penemu Dive Barracuda Point, Melissa's Garden and Keruo Channel, then explore turquoise lagoons by tender. A short hike gives one of Raja Ampat's classic limestone island views.	
DAY		PINNACLES
6	Wayilbatan The Four Kings pinnacles rise from the blue with reef fish, soft corals and schools of fusiliers. Later dives may include Neptune Fan Sea, Wedding Cake Wall and Barracuda Rock.	
DAYS		MISOOL
7-8	Boo and Fiabacet Dive photogenic sites such as Boo Windows, Nudi Rock, Tank Rock and Whale Rock. Weather permitting, visit Magic Mountain for mantas, sharks and vast schools of fish.	
DAY		FINAL DIVES
9	Farondi and Balbulol Explore underwater caves at Goa Farondi, search for pygmy seahorses and finish the diving around the current-swept pinnacles of Three Sisters.	
DAY		FAREWELL
10	Departure After breakfast, transfer to Sorong Airport with help for check-in and a head full of reef walls, mantas, coral gardens and late-night photo notes.	



YOUR LIVEABOARD

Nine nights aboard Damai II

Damai II is a 40-metre Indonesian phinisi built for serious diving, with spacious outside decks, outdoor dining, massage and spa areas, a large dive deck, camera room and high-speed tenders.

The source file lists twin or double ensuite accommodation, all-inclusive dining, tea, coffee, soft drinks, mineral water, selected beer and wine, complimentary massages, laundry service and all harbour fees.

For divers, Damai II brings experienced divemasters, a 4:1 diver-to-guide ratio, nitrox for certified divers and full dive equipment rental included in the source trip terms.

9

nights aboard the private
Damai II charter

12

guest maximum for an
intimate expedition

30

approximate planned dives,
including select night dives

4:1

listed diver-to-guide ratio
aboard Damai II

LIFE ON BOARD

Built for long dive days, image review and real downtime

Between dives, the source itinerary includes beach visits, lagoon cruises, short hikes, snorkelling, photo workshops, marine life presentations and evening chats with Brooke and the expedition team.

A typical day starts with coffee and a morning dive, then rolls through breakfast, more diving, lunch, rest, an afternoon dive, possible night dive, dinner and relaxed learning sessions on deck.

The ship's cabin, lounge and deck spaces matter on this route. Raja Ampat is remote, and the liveaboard is not just transport. It becomes the expedition base, classroom, camera room and quiet place to absorb what happened underwater.



"They truly made the experience unforgettable. Highly recommend Airguides to anyone looking for a unique, authentic and expertly curated adventure."

Adam McKnight, Raja 2025

THE DETAILS

What's included

Included

- Nine nights aboard Damai II private liveaboard
- One-night pre-trip stay in Sorong
- Airport and hotel transfers in Sorong
- Twin or double ensuite accommodation
- All-inclusive dining, tea, coffee, soft drinks and mineral water
- Selected beer and wine
- Complimentary massages and laundry service
- All harbour fees listed in the source file
- Full dive equipment rental
- Nitrox for certified divers
- Expert divemaster dive guides
- Two to four dives per day, including selected night dives
- Photography and editing masterclasses with Brooke
- One-on-one photo feedback session
- Marine biology presentations and Q&A sessions
- Trip gallery with professional photos and video by Brooke

Not Included

- International and domestic flights
- Post-trip hotel accommodation if required
- Travel and dive insurance, mandatory
- Raja Ampat National Park fee, listed as US\$150 in the source file
- Tips and gratuities
- Personal expenses
- Camera gear and camera insurance
- Laptop, Lightroom subscription and backup drives

Exact inclusions should be reconfirmed when new future dates are released.

FAQ

What guests usually need to know

Can you guarantee what we will see?

No. Raja Ampat is wild, and nature writes the script. The experienced captain, dive team and small-group liveaboard structure help create the best possible chances while keeping safety and animal welfare first.

Do I need to be a photographer?

No. Photography is optional. The trip suits divers who want world-class reefs, thoughtful guiding and a deeper connection to the ocean. Guests with cameras receive direct support from Brooke.

What certification is needed?

The source file says Open Water level or equivalent is the minimum. It also recommends Deep Diver specialty or Advanced Open Water, since some sites are best below 18 metres and current experience is useful.

Do I need insurance?

Yes. Comprehensive travel and dive insurance is essential, including scuba diving, medical emergencies, cancellations and other unexpected events.

What wildlife might we see?

Possibilities include oceanic mantas, reef mantas, turtles, octopus, sea snakes, wobbegong sharks, walking sharks, reef sharks, eagle rays, pygmy seahorses, nudibranchs, schooling jacks and soft coral gardens.

What camera should I bring?

A GoPro is a useful entry point. For more control, the source file recommends a compact or full-frame camera with manual controls, wide-angle or fisheye lens, underwater housing, spare batteries, SD cards and backup storage.

What is the water temperature?

The source FAQ lists typical water temperatures of 25 to 29 degrees Celsius. A full-length 3 mm wetsuit is recommended for warmth across multiple dives and protection from jellyfish or fire coral.

PRICING & DATES

Register interest for the next Raja Ampat departure

FUTURE DEPARTURES

TBC

The supplied brochure lists 31 January to 9 February 2026, which has already passed as of 16 May 2026. Current future dates were not visible on the Airguides site, so this brochure does not use stale book-now language.

PAST SOURCE PRICE

US\$8,950

The source file listed this price per person, with a US\$2,000 deposit and balance due 90 days before arrival. Final future pricing should be confirmed by Airguides.

Future dates to be confirmed

Indicative 10-day / 9-night format

This page is intended for post-lead-capture follow-up. Use it to build intent, then confirm dates, cabin availability, final price and current terms before taking payment.

READY?

Register interest in the next Raja Ampat expedition with Brooke

If Raja Ampat is the ocean trip you keep thinking about, get on the list now. Airguides will confirm future dates, price, cabin options and availability before asking for a deposit.

Register Your Interest

EMAIL

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PHONE / WHATSAPP

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WEBSITE

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